

IT Security Guidelines

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1. Password Policy

All employees must follow these password requirements for every company system:

Minimum Length: 12 characters. Passwords must include at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character (!@#\$%^&*).

Password Rotation: Passwords must be changed every 90 days. The system will not accept any of your last 10 passwords.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): MFA is mandatory for all company systems including email, VPN, cloud services, and the HR portal. Use the company-approved authenticator app -- SMS-based MFA is not accepted.

Password Storage: Never write down passwords or store them in plain text files. Use the company-provided password manager. Sharing passwords with colleagues is strictly prohibited, even with manager approval.

2. Data Protection and Classification

All company data is classified into four levels:

Public: Marketing materials, published blog posts, and press releases. No restrictions on sharing.

Internal: Company announcements, org charts, and internal processes. May be shared within the company but not externally without approval.

Confidential: Client data, financial reports, employee records, and business strategies. Access is limited to authorized personnel. Must be encrypted in transit and at rest.

Restricted: Trade secrets, source code, and security credentials. Access requires VP-level approval and is logged. Must be encrypted with AES-256 and stored only on company-approved systems.

Data Handling: All confidential and restricted data must be transmitted using encrypted channels (TLS 1.2 or higher). USB drives and personal cloud storage services are prohibited for transferring any company data above the Public classification level.

3. Incident Reporting

What is a security incident? Any event that compromises the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of company systems or data. Examples include:

- Unauthorized access to systems or data
- Lost or stolen devices (laptops, phones, USB drives)
- Suspicious emails or phishing attempts
- Malware infections
- Accidental data exposure

Reporting Process: Report all security incidents immediately to security@consoleflare.com or call the Security Operations Center at extension 5555. Do not attempt to investigate or resolve the incident yourself.

Response Times: Critical incidents (data breach, active attack) -- response within 15 minutes. High-priority incidents (malware, unauthorized access) -- response within 1 hour. Medium incidents (phishing, suspicious activity) -- response within 4 hours.

Non-Retaliation: ConsoleFlare has a strict non-retaliation policy. Employees who report incidents in good faith will not face any disciplinary action, even if the report turns out to be a false alarm.

4. Acceptable Use Policy

Company-Provided Equipment: Laptops, phones, and other devices are company property and must be used primarily for work purposes. Limited personal use is acceptable as long as it does not interfere with productivity or violate any policy.

Prohibited Activities: Installing unauthorized software, accessing inappropriate websites, using company resources for personal business ventures, cryptocurrency mining, or any illegal activity.

Network Security: Always connect through the company VPN when working remotely. Do not connect to public Wi-Fi without the VPN active. Do not share your VPN credentials.

Software Updates: Keep your operating system and all software up to date. Enable automatic updates where possible. Critical security patches must be installed within 48 hours of release.

Device Loss: Report lost or stolen devices within 1 hour to IT Support at support@consoleflare.com or extension 4444. IT will remotely wipe the device to protect company data.